AI.402

Robot Ethics

COURSE OVERVIEW

Ethics specific to robots: autonomy, responsibility, harm, and robot–human moral relationships.



ILLUSTRATIVE HERO IMAGERY

ROBOT ETHICS

1

SESSION

60 MINUTES

ORIENTATION: ETHICS OF ROBOTS

KEY TOPICS

- Robot ethics vs. AI ethics
- Moral agency of robots
- Responsibility gaps
- Course framework

TEACHING FOCUS

Ask what robots ought to do.

KEY TAKEAWAY Robots act in the world; their actions have moral weigh

ROBOT ETHICS

2

SESSION

60 MINUTES

AUTONOMY & RESPONSIBILITY

KEY TOPICS

- Moral responsibility
- Command responsibility
- Autonomous weapons
- Accountability chains

TEACHING FOCUS

Assign responsibility for robot acts.

▲ **KEY TAKEAWAY** When robots err, humans answer.

ROBOT ETHICS

3

SESSION

60 MINUTES

HARM & SAFETY

KEY TOPICS

- Physical harm
- Psychological harm
- Risk-benefit analysis
- Safe robot design

TEACHING FOCUS

Prevent robots from causing harm.

KEY TAKEAWAY Safety is an ethical obligation.

ROBOT ETHICS

4

SESSION

60 MINUTES

ROBOT RIGHTS & STATUS

KEY TOPICS

- Robot personhood debate
- Moral status of machines
- Property vs. person
- Legal perspectives

TEACHING FOCUS

Decide how the law sees robots.

▲ **KEY TAKEAWAY** Robots are tools—until society says otherwise.

5

SESSION

60 MINUTES

HUMAN–ROBOT MORAL RELATIONS

KEY TOPICS

- Trust and deception
- Emotional attachment
- Care robots and dignity
- Robot nudging

TEACHING FOCUS

Respect human–robot bonds.

KEY TAKEAWAY Relationships with robots shape human behavior.

ROBOT ETHICS

6

SESSION

60 MINUTES

ROBOT ETHICS & REVIEW

KEY TOPICS

- Case studies
- Course recap and assessment
- Toward AI ethics (AI.404)
- Ethics panel

TEACHING FOCUS

Apply ethical reasoning to robotics.

KEY TAKEAWAY Ethical robots serve humanity.